What Every Test is Really Telling You About Your Health

8

CRITICAL BLOOD TESTS

AND WHAT THEY MEAN FOR YOU

UNLOCK THE SECRETS OF YOUR BLOOD WORK

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8 CRITICAL BLOOD TESTS

AND <u>WHAT</u> THEY SAY ABOUT YOUR HEALTH

DISCLAIMER

Before you dive into the fascinating world of blood tests and what they can reveal about your health, there are a few important points I would like to address.

This ebook is a distillation of my personal journey, the knowledge I've gained, and the strategies I've employed to maintain and improve my own health. I've written it from the perspective of what I do for myself and what I look for in my own blood work. As such, the insights shared within these pages are a reflection of my personal experiences and understandings.

Please remember, health is a deeply personal and intricate thing, varying greatly from one individual to another. What works for me may not necessarily work for you. This ebook is not intended to replace professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment. Always seek the advice of your physician or other qualified health provider with any questions you may have regarding a medical condition. Never disregard professional medical advice or delay in seeking it because of something you have read in this ebook.

I want to stress that the purpose of this ebook is purely educational. It is a guide that offers you insight into the language of blood tests, helping you understand what these tests might mean in the context of health. It does not serve to prescribe, diagnose, or treat any health condition.

By understanding the role and importance of these 8 critical blood tests and what they can reveal about one's health, my aim is to empower you to become a more active participant in your health journey, more effectively communicate with your healthcare provider, and make more informed decisions about your health.

My hope is that you will find this guide helpful, informative, and enlightening.

8 CRITICAL BLOOD TESTS

AND WHAT THEY SAY ABOUT YOUR HEALTH

Dear Friend,

Not that long ago…your history and symptoms…were the most crucial information needed by your doctor to give you a diagnosis.

Your doctor would ask you questions and then LISTEN.

But…that's not the case anymore.

Today…it's all about testing. That's their solution to everything.

Your symptoms take a back seat to what your bloodwork says.

Sadly, if you're like most people who get routine blood tests…

The only explanation of the results you get are:

"*Everything looks good."*
"Your cholesterol is high."
"Your triglycerides are high."

Or…

"Your vitamin D is too low"…

Just kidding…doctors never check vitamin D status.

Let's face it…

You don't get much information.

Studies show only 36% of doctors ask open-ended questions to get patients to talk.

And when they do ask a question, such as:

"What brings you in here today?"

Studies also show you get an average of **11 seconds** to answer before being cut off.

11 seconds. That's <u>not</u> enough time.

How are you supposed to know where to start if you don't know what's going on?

Even if you google your results…

The internet is full of conflicting information. It's hard to know what's going on.

So…let me help you!

After **<u>100,000+ patient visits over 45+ year</u>**s…

I've discovered **8 critical blood tests** I look for on my blood work…

And I will share them with you in this short book.

Two Health Facts You Should Know:

Before we dive into the 8 blood tests…

There are two health facts you should know:

<u>HEALTH FACT #1</u>

A person doesn't go to sleep tonight and wake up with a disease tomorrow.

It takes months, years, and even decades for a condition **to show up**.

This is good news.

It means — <u>You have time</u> to turn things around.

<u>HEALTH FACT#2</u>

Your body gives **<u>clues</u>** as you move from health towards disease.

Now, <u>what do I mean by clues?</u>

The clues your body gives is like the check engine light on your car.

When the check engine light goes on — you can't say for sure what's going on.

It can be nothing at all, like not tightening the gas cap…

To something major, like engine failure.

Your body works the same way. Except you have many check engine lights.

For example — **Low energy is a check engine light.**

The cause of fatigue can be simple — not getting enough vitamin B12, for example…

Or it can be caused by something much more complicated…like hormones.

But, when you start to experience fatigue, **your body is telling you something is WRONG**.

Insomnia is another check engine light.

A healthy person can fall asleep, stay asleep, and wake up rested.

A person that's moving towards sickness can't.

The 8 critical blood tests are also "check engine lights".

When they're off…

Your body is telling you to pay attention.

The Law of Cause and Effect

One more thing…

Your body follows the law of **CAUSE** and **EFFECT**.

Symptoms are an effect.

Pain is an effect.

Insomnia is an effect.

You don't fix the problem by fixing the effect. You must FIX the CAUSE!

This is where doctors get it wrong.

When you treat only the symptoms — it's like turning up the radio when your engine starts to make weird noises.

Does that solve the problem?

Yet…this is exactly what happens when you simply take drugs to eliminate pain, or fall asleep, or whatever else you're trying to overcome.

Who is this book for?

It's rare…a day goes by…that we don't get someone who messages us on our website or Facebook, sends us an email, or even calls us because they're desperate for help.

They're exhausted…or can't sleep no matter what they try…or are gaining weight for no reason at all…or their hormones are an absolute disaster…, or their gut is in bad shape. …They can't figure out why…or they're so stressed they've become anxious about everything…even their brain is failing them to the point it feels like they're losing their minds.

Bottom line…they're a mess and feel hopeless because…

Their doctors usually can't find anything wrong with them, no matter how much blood work or tests they get done.

I can feel their frustration and emotion with every word they type or say to us.

Something has to change for them…and <u>it has to change now.</u>
Most people are trapped in something I call the "medical merry-go-round".

Here's what I mean by that…

Health is like oxygen. You NEVER think about it until it's gone.

And when it's gone…

That's all you think about.

Imagine a person…let's call her Mary…is feeling healthy…

She's got good energy, she's sleeping well, and her body isn't in any type of pain.

Then, she wakes up one day and notices her energy isn't quite the same.

(As I mentioned earlier, low energy is a check engine light.)

Oddly enough…even though she's tired…she's not sleeping well or waking up refreshed.

This goes on for a while and eventually….

Mary makes an appointment to see her family physician.

I call this the "<u>**drug stage**</u>" of the <u>medical merry-go-round</u>.

Mary's doctor orders many tests…and they mostly come back normal…except…

Her cholesterol is a "little high."

Now…her cholesterol being off a little has NOTHING to do with her fatigue…

But since her doctor couldn't find anything in her blood work to explain low energy…

The doctor starts doing what they've been trained to do… prescribes cholesterol-lowering drugs (statins) to deal with Mary's high numbers.

Mary went to see her doctor for fatigue…and left on meds for cholesterol.

Since nothing has been done to fix the problem…Mary's fatigue gets worse.

And, Mary starts to get other symptoms as well. She's waking up often throughout the night, and her hair doesn't seem as healthy as before.

This can go on for a while.

After many visits to her doctor (and specialists), Mary will eventually get diagnosed with a disease…

Heart disease, or diabetes, or hypothyroidism.

Mary started off healthy…and is now on many meds (most prescribed to counter symptoms from other meds)…and is currently dealing with a chronic illness.

This is the medical merry-go-round many of you are trapped inside.

If that sounds like you…then you're in the right place.

It's now time to talk about the 8 critical blood tests.

BLOOD TEST #1
THE TRIGLYCERIDE/HDL RATIO

For over ten years, I coached youth hockey.

It was a lot of fun, and it was fantastic to see the improvement in the kids each year as the season went on.

I remember a game, early in one of the seasons, one of the players on my team ended up with the puck on his stick and saw nothing but open space to the net.

You could see the smile and excitement on his face.

He skated as hard as possible, determined to take advantage of the breakaway.

To his surprise, nobody from the other team caught up to him…

So he leaned on his stick and shot the puck as hard as possible towards the net.

Except there was one problem.

It was his own net.

He was skating the wrong way and was shooting at the WRONG target.

This story reminds me of doctors and cholesterol.

They're shooting at the wrong target.

How else do you explain almost 70% of the people who suffer heart attacks have normal or even 'perfect' cholesterol levels???

Sadly, doctors are trained to believe that cholesterol is always bad and that everyone needs to take cholesterol-lowering drugs.

"TAKE MORE DRUGS!!!"

That's their solution to everything. More drugs. More drugs. More drugs. (It kinda makes you wonder who they're really working for, huh!)

Obviously, cholesterol drugs are not the "magic bullets" the drug industry would have you believe.

Hundreds of millions of people around the world are taking cholesterol-lowering drugs. And many have been taking them for years…even decades.

But sadly, heart disease is STILL the #1 killer of Canadians and Americans, responsible for nearly one-third of ALL deaths. It kills more men and women each year than all cancers combined, including breast cancers.

So…

If cholesterol is NOT the best indicator of heart disease or a risk of heart attack…

Then what is?

The Triglyceride/HDL ratio (TG/HDL ratio for short).

What are triglycerides?

Triglycerides are a type of fat, and they are the main thing that makes up your fat cells.

All you need to know is that the primary function of triglycerides is to store energy.

So…

If you have high triglycerides…

It's because you're storing too much energy.

But, what does that mean?

When you eat crappy carbs (fats + sugar combined), sugar, too many carbs, overeat food in a day, or eat too often…

Your blood sugar levels SPIKE.

That's a problem because…high blood sugar levels **are toxic** and dangerous…so your body *has* to eliminate the excess glucose IMMEDIATELY.

You can't keep the extra glucose in your blood. That's life-threatening.

So…

You must somehow remove the extra glucose and quickly move it elsewhere.

This is what insulin does.

Insulin clears the glucose out of your blood and moves it into storage.

To keep things simple…

If you consume too much energy (food, especially crappy carbs), you end up with too much insulin…

And eventually you end up with high triglycerides.

HOW TO CALCULATE YOUR TG/HDL RATIO

To get your TG/HDL ratio, simply take the triglyceride and divide it by the HDL.

The closer to 1 — the better.

Optimally…you want your HDL to be higher than your Triglycerides.

Now…

If your TG/HDL ratio is over 3, your risk of heart disease, stroke, or heart attack goes up significantly.

<u>HEART DISEASE</u> AND THE TG/HDL RATIO

A 1997 Harvard study found:

People with the highest Triglycerides (TG) and lowest HDL were 16 times more likely to die of heart disease than those with the lowest TG and highest HDL (1).

Based on the study…high TG and low HDL are terrible and put you at risk of death.

On the flip side, low TG and high HDL lowered the risk of death from heart disease.

This means…low TG and high HDL should be your goal.

<u>FATTY LIVER</u> AND THE TG/HDL RATIO

Another study examined the relationship between the TG/HDL ratio and fatty liver.

The study found close to 60% of people in the group with the highest TG/HDL ratio had fatty liver (2).

Interestingly, the study showed that the TG/HDL ratio connection to the fatty liver was evident even in HEALTHY PEOPLE.

You may feel good and healthy…but if your TG/HDL ratio is high…then you have or are at risk for fatty liver.

A more recent study…published this month (Sept 2022)…got even more specific about the connection between TG/HDL ratio and fatty liver (3).

This new study found anything higher than a 1.64 ratio…

Was a risk for fatty liver.

And…

A ratio of 2.48 or higher was at risk for metabolic syndrome.

Based on this study…

If your ratio is over 1.5 — it's time to change your diet.

And keep in mind…

Liver fat is a special kind of nasty fat.

When a liver gets fatty, you end up with **Type-2 Diabetes**.

When a liver gets fatty, your **thyroid** doesn't work as well.

When a liver gets fatty, you **don't detoxify** as well.

Basically, a fatty liver is never a good thing.

SLUGGISH THYROID AND THE TG/HDL RATIO

Your SENSITIVITY to thyroid hormones is related to your **triglycerides** and **HDL**.

If your triglyceride levels are HIGH…then you risk becoming less sensitive to thyroid hormones.

On the other hand…

If your HDL levels are HIGH…your sensitivity to thyroid hormones increases.

Remember…**you WANT to be MORE SENSITIVE.**

WEIGHT GAIN AND THE TG/HDL RATIO

Not long ago…

Researchers discovered that triglycerides can cross your blood-brain barrier…

And interfere with another hormone called LEPTIN.

Leptin plays a critical role in your metabolism because it…

- Tells your brain that you're full.
- Increases your metabolism to help burn off the food you just ate.
- Increases your energy output since you have more to burn.
- Increases your thyroid hormones.

Essentially…

<u>Leptin helps you maintain your weight.</u>

This brings up an interesting question…

If we have leptin…a built-in mechanism to keep us at a healthy weight…

Then <u>**why do we become obese?**</u>

I mean…

We eat food.

We secrete leptin.

Our brain tells us we are full.

Our metabolism ramps up.

We burn the extra energy.

So…<u>**how is it possible to gain weight?**</u>

It's because of something called **LEPTIN RESISTANCE.**

After a while…our brain can stop listening to leptin.

It simply ignores it.

Even though you're storing fat and secreting leptin…the brain doesn't see it anymore.

Now…this leads to another problem.

Every hormone has a counter hormone.

One that does the complete opposite.

I talk about insulin all the time.

But I hardly ever talk about its counter hormone — glucagon.

Insulin helps lower blood sugar, and glucagon helps raise blood sugar.

Leptin has a counter hormone as well…

GHRELIN.

Everything that leptin does…Ghrelin does the opposite.

Ghrelin tells your brain that you're hungry. It slows down your metabolism and your thyroid.

When you become leptin resistant…

Then your brain ignores leptin…

But will still listen to ghrelin.

That's how you can be hungry…even though you have plenty of stored energy ready to use.

SUMMARY OF TG/HDL RATIO

The TG/HDL ratio is a good indicator of:

Risk of heart disease.

Risk of Fatty Liver
Risk of Metabolic Syndrome
Thyroid hormone sensitivity

HOW TO LOWER TRIGLYCERIDES AND RAISE HDL

Despite what doctors say, your triglycerides aren't high because you overeat saturated fat.

That's an outdated belief pushed by food companies to get people to eat their low-fat cereals.

If you have high triglycerides, it's because of increased circulating insulin.

So…you have to lower insulin first.

Now…

Lowering insulin always starts with FOOD.

While everyone is giving up coffee, meat, eggs, fatty foods, sunshine, and all things that make life livable…

You DON'T have to.

I created the METABOLIC RESET (otherwise known as the eggs, meat, and cheese diet) to help lower insulin.

You can learn more about the Metabolic Reset by visiting our website at martinclinic.com

SUPPLEMENTS TO HELP THE TG/HDL RATIO

When it comes to supplements, there are a few we like to help lower triglycerides and raise HDL.

DHA

Studies show higher dosage of Omega-3 (3.4 grams/day) "significantly lowered triglycerides."

Again, it's essential to know not all Omega-3 Fatty acids are created equal.

Our preferred type of Omega-3 is high DHA.

Omega-3s (DHA) are also good for your liver.

In a new study…

Patients with fatty liver were given Omega-3 supplements every day for 6 months.

For context…

The breakdown of the Omega-3 dosage per day was 1509mg of DHA and 306mg of EPA.

(I think that's too low.)

Here's what they found:

After 6 months…

There was a **SIGNIFICANT** reduction in liver fibrosis and the enzyme ALP.

That's exciting.

Even a low dose of DHA and EPA significantly reduced scar tissue.

Here's something even more exciting…

The enzyme ALP (Alkaline Phosphatase) is present when there is DAMAGE to your liver.

After 6 months…

Those who took the dosage of DHA and EPA reversed much of the damage to their liver.

Now…

As I mentioned…

The dosage was too low.

I believe the results would have been even better had they taken more DHA.

Anthocyanin's

Anthocyanin extracts fight inflammation, protect cells from free radicals, and raise HDL levels.

The best anthocyanin supplement is **PINE BARK EXTRACT** (Navitol)…

Because it contains the best type…

Oligomeric Proanthocyanidins (OPCs). These are known as super-polyphenols and are much stronger than other antioxidants.

OPCs fight free radicals that cause accelerated aging and are crucial for supporting healthy circulation and strengthening capillaries. And they do this better than any others.

But you need a high concentration of OPCs to get the full benefit!

So the higher the percentage of OPCs you take, the more active ingredient you get, AND the more powerful free radical neutralizers you get working in your body.

Pine Bark Extract contains over 80% OPC level - much higher than the 5% many other polyphenols contain.

One Navitol capsule contains **350mg** of our Pine Bark Extract!

BLOOD TEST #2
A1C

To understand the importance of the A1C test…

Then we must talk about INSULIN RESISTANCE.

Most people know insulin is a food hormone…meaning it's released when you eat.

When you eat crappy carbs (fats + sugar combined), sugar, too many carbs, overeat food in a day, or eat too often…

Then your blood sugar levels SPIKE.

That's a problem because…high blood sugar levels **are toxic** and dangerous…so your body *has* to eliminate the excess glucose IMMEDIATELY.

If you don't need the energy right away…then you have to store the glucose somewhere because it has to be removed from your blood ASAP.

This is where insulin steps in.

Insulin moves glucose out of your blood and into storage.

What happens if you constantly need insulin to help clean glucose out of your blood?

At first…not much.

I had a TV remote that used to drive me crazy.

At first…it worked with zero problems.

Press the power button…and the TV is turned on.

Then, I noticed I'd have to push the button a few times to get the TV to turn on.

Soon after…I had to push the button harder and more often to simply turn on the TV…

Pushing the power button harder allowed more carbon in the rubber to get closer to the contacts in the circuit board…allowing it to work.

Something that used to require a simple push…now needed a lot more effort to do the same job.

That's similar to what happens to your cells and insulin.

When things are working fine…you need a little insulin to trigger a cellular response to remove glucose from your blood.

But…if you constantly need more insulin…eventually, your cells STOP listening.

When that happens — you make more insulin?

If you continue to spike your blood sugar…then eventually, you need even MORE insulin to get the job done.

And that's a significant problem.

High circulating insulin is the **#1 cause** of most chronic diseases…

Heart disease, diabetes, many cancers, Alzheimer's, Dementia, autoimmune disorders…

This is why I talk about high insulin all the time.

As I mentioned…

Insulin is a food hormone.

But — it's also a **GROWTH HORMONE**.

Insulin makes things grow…

Fat cells…Prostate…Skin tags…cancer cells…

It can all grow with too much circulating insulin.

Alright…

Let’s talk about the A1C test.

A1C is a blood test that measures your average blood sugar levels over the past three months.

If your A1C is high…

Then your blood sugar has been higher than it should have been over the last three months…

This means…you’ve needed more insulin to help clear the glucose from your blood.

OPTIMAL A1C RESULTS

I consider anything over 5.4 on an A1C test to indicate insulin resistance.

A person with an A1C over 5.4 may suffer from:

Fatigue
High blood pressure
High Triglycerides
Inflammation and pain
Fatty Liver
Hair Loss
Sarcopenia (muscle wasting)
Osteoporosis
Humpback
Skin tags
Erectile dysfunction
Swollen prostate
Sluggish Thyroid
Estrogen Dominance
Gout
Kidney Stones
Psoriasis
Brain fog
Memory issues

Insomnia
Metabolic Syndrome
Vertigo
Tinnitus
Carpal Tunnel Syndrome
Acne
Overactive Bladder

…you can see how wide and diverse the symptoms of insulin resistance.

How do you fix Insulin Resistance and lower A1C?

Food is the #1 place to start if you want to FIX insulin.

We created the **METABOLIC RESET** for that purpose…to fix insulin.

BLOOD TEST #3
B12

B12 deficiency is a common disorder affecting millions of people in North America.

One reason it's common…doctors aren't trained to look for it…and the serum B-12 test is unreliable.

But…those aren't the only reasons why B12 deficiency is common.

You can't absorb B12 in your stomach without something called intrinsic factor.

Intrinsic factor is secreted by your stomach, enabling you to absorb B12.

Which means…

If you have ANY digestive issues, you'll have a problem absorbing B12.

Many common medications also directly affect your B12 levels….

Proton Pump Inhibitors (acid reflux), Metformin (Metabolic syndrome, diabetes), H2RA's (Zantac, Pepcid, etc…), Antibiotics, many NSAIDs (anti-inflammatory)…

All lower your B12.

And…

Drinking alcohol (even wine) ROBS you of B12.

Throw in the fact most of the world is scared of red meat…and you have a recipe for population-wide low B12.

The problem with B12 deficiency…it causes a lot of different…and sometimes weird symptoms.

You need B12 to make red blood cells, nerves, and DNA…

This is why you can have many different symptoms all over your body, inside and out…

Symptoms include heart palpitations, shortness of breath, a lump in your throat, depression, anxiety, faintness, tinnitus, muscle spasms, twitches, confusion and dementia, dizziness, numbness, tingling, or burning in your hands, arms, legs, and feet.

Read that list again. Every system in our body is represented.

Let me highlight 3 symptoms.

First…The most common symptom is **FATIGUE**.

It makes sense because B12 is often called the "energy vitamin."

It's impossible to have energy if you don't have enough red blood cells…

And you need B12 at the cellular level to make energy.

Your brain needs B12.

1 in 3 seniors dies with Alzheimer's or another dementia. It kills more than breast cancer and prostate cancer COMBINED.

Alzheimer's and dementia are BIG problems.

The health of your brain is like a 1000-piece jigsaw puzzle.

Every piece is needed to complete the puzzle…

Lose just one piece, and the whole puzzle is ruined.

There are a lot of 'pieces' when it comes to making sure your body doesn't outlive your brain…

And B12 is a big one.

A chronic B12 deficiency can cause your brain to shrink…it can literally cause your brain to rot.

Nerve Pain or Neuropathy

Your nerves are protected by an outer layer called the 'myelin sheath.'

Without protection from the myelin sheath, your nerves can't function.

When you don't get enough B12 — it could damage the myelin sheaths protecting your nerves.

Here's the thing…

MILD B12 deficiency can lead to neuropathy (pain, numbness, tingling) of your extremities.

Alright…

Let's talk about the B12 test.

Most "alternative" doctors agree the optimal levels for B12 are…

800-1200 pmol/L.

As mentioned…

If your B12 levels aren't optimal…

Then you're most likely TIRED, have poor concentration, and are at risk of brain disorders. You may already have heart palpitations and neuropathy or nerve pain.

How do you fix low B12?

If you have a digestive issue already…

Even "mild" problems like bloating, heartburn, indigestion…

Then you have to also fix your gut.

Digestive enzymes and Probiotics are a good place to start.

It goes without saying…

If you're low in B12…then you need a B12 supplement.

But… there's a significant problem.

Let me explain…

Did you know every lump of coal contains gasoline?

But good luck trying to use coal in your car's gas tank.

Even though a lump of coal CONTAINS gasoline… it's in a form that's USELESS to your car…

And most B12 supplements are in the WRONG form.

First of all…

If you swallow a pill that has vitamin B12 in it… it's useless.

As I mentioned earlier…you need intrinsic factor in your stomach to absorb B12…

B12 supplements must be in a SUBLINGUAL form (a tablet that dissolves under the tongue).

Also…

99.9% of vitamin B12 on the market comes in the form of cyanocobalamin.

Cyanocobalamin is FAKE NEWS. It doesn't exist in nature. It's unnatural. It's completely fabricated in a lab.

It's also not effective.

Instead…

B12 needs to be in the form of **METHYLCOBALAMIN**.

But…

Methylcobalamin is more expensive and harder to get.

As you can see…

Just because a supplement contains vitamin B12…

Doesn't mean it's in a form your body can actually use.

That's one way you end up with expensive urine.

In short…

You need to take a sublingual methylcobalamin B12 supplement.

One more thing.

Not long ago…

Doctors used to give B12 shots. That's rare today.

B12 deficiency is overlooked and minimized by mainstream medicine.

But…the good news…you don't need to get a B12 shot to help your levels to be normal.

You may be surprised to learn that an oral B12 is just as effective as getting a B12 shot…

AND you don't have to experience the discomfort of needles.

A study published last year showed (again) oral B12 is EQUAL to injectable B12…

And this study was done on gastric bypass patients.

Remember…

To absorb B12, you need

You need a substance called intrinsic factor.

Intrinsic factor is secreted by your stomach, enabling you to absorb B12.

Gastric bypass patients have MUCH less intrinsic factor and are almost always low in B12.

If there was a group of people who would do better with a B12 shot, it would be gastric bypass patients.

BUT…

They did just as well on an oral B12.

Another thing we like about taking an oral B12…

Is that you can take it every day.

This helps to maintain an average blood level of B12.

When you get a B12 shot every month…

Your levels increase quickly…

Then slowly decrease the rest of the month.

Many people who get B12 shots feel good for the first week and then notice a gradual decline in energy until their next shot.

There's no need for that.

There's no need to have fluctuating energy.

BLOOD TEST #4
VITAMIN D

I believe your blood levels of Vitamin D might be one of the most important biomarkers of health.

Studies show the average blood level of vitamin D starts to decrease in September.

It's no coincidence that the flu mainly occurs in the fall and winter.

We need UVB from the sun to make vitamin D., And fewer people walk around in shorts and t-shirts in winter…

Our blood **vitamin D levels start to plummet**.

But sadly, most people have extremely low levels year round.

Years ago…coal miners didn't have the technology to detect deadly poisonous gases like methane or carbon dioxide…

So, they used canaries.

Long before a poisonous gas would get to a level needed to kill a human…

It would kill a canary.

A dead canary was a warning sign that something terrible was about to happen.

Our body works the same way.

There are warning signs your body gives you that something terrible is coming.

The problem is…most of the time…the warnings are ignored.

Your blood levels of vitamin D are a canary in the coal mine.

Low vitamin D disrupts EVERY system in your body.

Here are a few ways low vitamin D wreaks havoc on your health:

VITAMIN D AND YOUR IMMUNE SYSTEM

EVERY cell in your body NEEDS vitamin D…Especially your Killer T-cells.

Your Killer T-cells need vitamin D to react to enemies…including viruses.

When your body gets exposed to a virus or bacteria or cancer cell…

Your **T-cells search for vitamin D** to activate.

They will not complete the activation process if they can't find enough Vitamin D.

Think about that for a minute.

Your T-cells won't fully activate unless you have enough vitamin D.

It's hard to fight off a virus or cancer without your killer T-cells.

That's how critical vitamin D is to your immune system.

Now, let's talk about Vitamin D and this new virus.

Vitamin D seems to favorably modulate our immune response to the virus, both in the early stages and even the later hyperinflammatory phases of COVID-19.

Research has already shown **Vitamin D levels in COVID-19 can affect the outcome**.

Blood vitamin D levels were LOWEST in critical cases…

And HIGHEST in mild cases.

Meaning — the more optimized blood vitamin D levels are, the better the outcome.

They also found an increase in blood levels of vitamin D could improve clinical outcomes…

Whereas a decrease in blood levels of vitamin D could worsen clinical outcomes.

And more recently…

A small study was done on patients hospitalized for COVID-19 and found…

Vitamin D reduces the risk of ICU admissions by 97%.

In fact, out of the 76 people in the trial, ONLY 1 out of 50 people who took vitamin D required ICU admission compared to 13 out of 26% (50%) who did not take it!

I don't know about you, but vitamin D should be discussed more often…

Especially considering the time of year.

VITAMIN D AND YOUR BRAIN

A study published this past year in the American Journal of Clinical Nutrition showed a link between vitamin D deficiency and dementia.

The study looked at data and brain scans from more than 300,000 people and concluded there's a…

… "causal effect of vitamin D deficiency on dementia."

We've known about the relationship between low vitamin D and dementia for a long time.

Here's something I wrote 5 years ago:

"A study in JAMA Neurology linked low vitamin D levels to PROFOUND and RAPID cognitive decline."

The study found low levels of Vitamin D were associated with THREE times faster rate of cognitive decline than those with adequate levels."

VITAMIN D AND YOUR BLOOD VESSELS

You have over 60,000 miles of blood vessels in your body! Your blood vessels could easily circle the globe. They also carry over a million barrels of blood in your lifetime.

Daily, your heart pumps about 1,800 gallons of blood through your blood vessels. Needless to say, you need every square inch of your blood vessels to be healthy for you to live!

A key component of healthy blood vessels is the Teflon-like inner lining…the endothelium.

When the endothelium is healthy, blood flows smoothly. But what happens when the Teflon-like inner lining no longer works?

When this happens, blood won't flow as well as it should. It also puts *you at risk* for blood clots and heart attacks! You end up with Endothelial Dysfunction.

Well…

Vitamin D helps STABILIZE the endothelium, which helps PREVENT vascular leaks.

Vascular leak is common in cardiovascular disease, arthritis, multiple sclerosis, and sepsis.

Getting vitamin D is easy and one of the best things a person can do to protect EVERY system in their body.

Sadly, few don't get anywhere near enough vitamin D., And it's not their fault.

The media, public health, doctors, and "experts" discourage vitamin D.

They scare people enough to avoid the sun…

And they freak out whenever someone takes a vitamin D supplement.

If I had a dollar for every time I've heard, "My doctor says it's dangerous to take more than 1000 IU of vitamin D, "… I'd buy premium gas just for fun.

But here's what really gets me going:

Canada and the U.S. have significant vitamin D deficiency problems.

One study found between 70% and 97% of Canadians are low in vitamin D. That's a public health crisis.

The same study found if Canadians took only 2000IU per day…93% of Canadians would achieve normal blood levels.

Yet…few doctors know this…and even if they did… they'd still only recommend 1000IU per day as the max.

Now, let me be clear…the vitamin D blood levels that doctors consider normal...

Are considerably different from what most integrative healthcare practitioners consider optimal.

I've said this before…

There's a war going on over Vitamin D.

For the past two years…any mention of vitamin D got you banned from most social media platforms.

This may sound crazy…

I think Vitamin D is so simple and cost-effective…

If more people got the amount needed to bring their blood levels of vitamin D to an optimal range…

Drug companies would see their revenues drop considerably.

One more thing…

The older you are…

The less your body produces vitamin D from the sun.

For example…a 70-year-old makes **4 TIMES LESS vitamin D** than a 20-year-old.

Now…

Imagine a 70-year-old wearing sunscreen?

How much vitamin D do you think they're getting in the summer?

Clearly, most people need to supplement vitamin D.

BLOOD TEST #5
THYROID

As I look back over my 45+ years in clinical practice…

The thyroid has to be one of the most misunderstood and poorly treated body parts in all medicine.

Here's a typical sluggish thyroid person's experience:

They're exhausted… gaining weight… their hair is falling out or thinning for no reason at all…or they're feeling depressed…and their skin is really dry all of a sudden…, or they have no more sex drive…

They can't figure out why…and now they're so stressed they've become anxious about everything…even their brain is failing them. It feels like they're losing their minds.

Bottom line… they're a mess and feel hopeless because… they're convinced their thyroid is the problem, but…

Their doctors usually can't find anything wrong with them, no matter how much blood work or tests they get done.

As I've said before…

EVERYTHING you've been told about your thyroid is WRONG.

How can a person have almost EVERY symptom of hypothyroidism…

Yet have *NORMAL* blood tests?

Why can't doctors find anything wrong?

And if the doctors do happen to find something wrong and prescribe meds…

Usually, one of two things happens.

Either the meds have to be constantly adjusted…

Or the medication "fixes" the problem…the bloodwork goes back to normal…

But the person *STILL* feels terrible.

How can this be happening to **MILLIONS** of women?

Obviously…there has to be something more than a simple "thyroid" problem going on.

And…

The problem isn't in your head…no matter what doctors say.

The most important thing to remember…

When it comes to thyroid testing…

I believe that SYMPTOMS are more important than testing.

It's not that testing isn't essential…

It's just that doctors forget how the thyroid works…they forget that the thyroid is not in charge… it's only doing what it's told to do.

Your thyroid has a boss — the hypothalamus.

And to make things more complicated…

There is a middleman between your hypothalamus and thyroid. That middleman is your pituitary gland.

So…

The hypothalamus tells the pituitary gland to get your thyroid going.

How does the pituitary gland get your thyroid going?

Your pituitary releases a hormone called Thyroid Stimulating Hormone (TSH), which tells your thyroid to make hormones.

Now…

Your thyroid makes two essential hormones called…**T3** and T4.

All you need to know for now is that **T3 is a potent metabolism regulator**. You need T3 to function. You need T3 for energy, and you need **T3 to lose fat**.

But…90% of the hormones produced by the thyroid come in the form of T4.

This means you have to convert T4 into the active form T3…

And this is where a majority of thyroid problems come from.

You need T4 to convert to T3 so that you can…

Breath properly
have a regular Heart rate
have healthy Central and peripheral nervous systems
be at a normal Bodyweight
have Muscle strength
have normal Menstrual cycles
keep a balanced Body temperature

…and so many other functions…

BUT…and this is critical…

Even though your thyroid is TINY (it weighs less than 25 grams)…

It's POWERFUL.

Your thyroid only makes about 1 TEASPOON of thyroid hormones over a FULL YEAR!

Can you see why it's hard to test?

The smallest decrease in thyroid hormone production can have devastating effects on you.

Here are a few more things you should know about your thyroid…

If you have a CORTISOL problem…you will also have a THYROID problem because…

Cortisol STOPS the conversion of T4 into T3.

And…

If you have too much estrogen (estrogen dominance)…you will also have a thyroid problem because…

Estrogen increases Thyroid Binding Globulin (TBG).

All you need to know is TBG binds and carries the thyroid hormones throughout your body.

This is a good thing.

BUT, a problem occurs when there's too much TBG…because ALL your thyroid hormones get bound up…

And **no free thyroid hormones means no ability for them to do their job.**

This results in sluggish thyroid symptoms…

AND will **NOT** show up on standard thyroid blood testing.

So… here's where we're at right now…

The thyroid can be sluggish because of a hypothalamus or pituitary problem…

Or it can be sluggish because of a problem with the thyroid itself…

Or a problem converting T4 into T3.

Or you have too much cortisol…

Or you have too much estrogen…

Or have you had too much insulin…

As you can see, the thyroid is complex.

Alright…

Let's talk about thyroid testing…

In my experience…a TSH greater than 1 in blood tests usually correlates with sluggish thyroid symptoms.

TSH > 1 = SYMPTOMS

But…as I mentioned…I care more about the patient's hiSTORY than I do about actual thyroid testing.

We also created a supplement called THYROID BALANCE FORMULA.

Thyroid Balance Formula includes ingredients designed to...

...give your thyroid all the nutrients it needs to significantly boost T3 production and support all aspects of thyroid function.

Besides iodine Thyroid Balance Formula also includes the following ingredients:

Tyrosine helps your thyroid make the hormones you need to be healthy.

Watermelon Extract boosts T3 and T4 further and increases your metabolism to help you lose weight easier.

L-carnitine is an ammo acid that helps regulate the Thyroid.

Selenium is one of the nutrients most deficient in our modern-day diets today, which is used by your body to convert T4 to T3.

And last but not least, **Resveratrol** is an antioxidant that is vital for your body and helps with the production of Thyroid Stimulating Hormone (TSH), which you need.

And all together…?

These ingredients inside our formula work in synergy to bring your Thyroid back into balance to repair and overcome your thyroid problems.

BLOOD TEST #6
CRP

It wasn't long ago that doctors only mentioned inflammation if someone was in pain.

In their opinion…

Inflammation was the CAUSE of the pain…

And the solution was to get rid of the inflammation using drugs.

Now…we (should) know better.

Inflammation is involved in EVERY problem in our body…

From heart disease to autoimmune disorders and Alzheimer's.

All the cells in your body talk with each other using chemicals and hormones.

To do that…

All cells have receptors…mini-antennas…that detect the different chemicals and hormones your body makes.

The receptor's only job is to transmit the information from outside the cell to the inside.

For any hormone or chemical to work…

Your cell receptors have to be able to detect the hormone.

If your cell receptors aren't working correctly…they can't detect the chemical or hormone…and cell communication essentially dies.

Now…

Have you ever tried driving in thick fog?

The type of fog where you can barely see a few feet in front of your car?

That's what inflammation does to all your cell receptors. It makes it hard for receptors to detect chemicals and hormones.

When cells can't communicate…things go wrong.

Inflammation disrupts how your cells talk to each other.

BUT…and this part is often overlooked…

Inflammation doesn't just magically appear. Something has to cause it.

It isn't enough to say…inflammation is the cause of heart disease, autoimmune disorders, or even Alzheimer's…and all you have to do is get rid of it, and you will be healed.

It's not that simple. If it was that easy…then anti-inflammatories would fix everything.

Having said all this…inflammation is still a critical biomarker.

Over my 45+ years in healthcare, I often speak of two health facts:

1 - You don't go to bed healthy and wake up with a disease the next day.
2 - Your body gives clues as it moves from health to disease.

Why does this matter to you?

Because disease can take years (even decades) to show up…

And that's both a good and bad thing.

Obviously…the more time you have before disease sets in…the more time you have to fix the problem.

BUT…since many of the "early" clues your body gives are generic…fatigue, insomnia, digestive issues…

The symptoms are often overlooked or minimized.

An early clue that indicates your health is heading in the wrong direction is inflammation.

Now…

Inflammation is often called the "silent killer" because it can be "subclinical"…

Meaning…you have NO symptoms.

Your health can be headed toward disaster…and you may have only minimal symptoms.

So…

Let's talk about how inflammation is measured in your body.

The CRP Blood Test

Doctors use a blood test called CRP to check inflammation levels.

CRP is a "marker" that gets produced when there's **any** inflammation in your body...

Such as when you suffer an acute injury or an infection or ingest damaging elements such as alcohol, cigarette smoke, air pollution, or toxins.

Chronically elevated levels of CRP reveal a state of *systemic inflammation* - which means your entire body is in an "irritated" condition. And this is what causes many different kinds of lethal diseases.

For example, inflammation and irritation can lead to clogged arteries and most heart attacks. Chronic inflammation can result in a heart attack or stroke.

In short…

You want LOW inflammation levels.

In fact…the CRP blood test results should be as close to zero as possible.

When your CRP levels are high, you're at risk of:

Heart disease
Cancer
Autoimmune Diseases
Metabolic Syndrome
Depression
Skin Disorders
Gut issues
Pain
Thyroid disorders

One often overlooked problem of too much inflammation is…

AGING.

You have both chronological age and biological age.

Your biological age is how fast your skin, muscle, heart, immune, bone, and liver cells…are aging.

A 50-year-old may have a biological age of 70…

Whereas a 70-year-old may have a biological age of a 55-year-old.

Inflammation is directly related to your biological age because it…

Causes free radical damage that rusts out your cells.
Mitochondrial dysfunction kills your energy.
Weakens your immune system and makes you sick.
Actually changes your genetics.
Disrupts your hormones.

Now…how do you lower your CRP?

By fixing the 3 leading causes.

INSULIN

Doctors have known for a long time (or should have known) that high circulating insulin directly causes inflammation.

One study — done 21 years ago — looked at the relationship between CRP levels and insulin and concluded:

"We suggest that chronic subclinical inflammation is part of insulin resistance syndrome."

Many with chronic inflammation have way too much insulin.

I also want to notice the word "subclinical" mentioned in the study.

Inflammation is often called the "silent killer" because a person can have high levels…

And have NO symptoms.

Now… I'd argue that they probably do have some symptoms…but they're often overlooked or minimized.

LEAKY GUT SYNDROME

The "wall" of your gut, or your gut lining, is the barrier that protects the rest of your body against toxins.

It is the **ONLY barrier** between your BLOOD system and the food you eat.

You don't want candida, bacteria, parasites, undigested food, or toxins in your bloodstream. That's when your health is at risk.

When your gut lining begins to break down, toxins' leak' into your bloodstream and other systems of your body…creating a significant health hazard.

It also causes a LOT of inflammation.

FREE RADICAL DAMAGE

You know what happens to a sliced apple left on the counter for a few hours. It turns brown and nasty.

That's free radical damage at work, the same damage they're doing inside your body.

You can't see the process on the inside, but you can see and feel it on the outside.

If you already notice unsightly age spots on your hands or face, fine lines, wrinkles, or less energy and vitality — that's free radical damage in action.

All you need to know is that free radicals cause inflammation…

And the more free radicals…, the more inflammation.

Now…

Let's talk about the best ways to lower inflammation.

#1 LOWER INSULIN

Lowering insulin always starts with FOOD.

While everyone is giving up coffee, meat, eggs, fatty foods, sunshine, and all things that make life livable…

You DON'T have to.

I created the METABOLIC RESET (the eggs, meat, and cheese diet) to help lower insulin.

In my opinion… it's the best way to fix high insulin.

#2 FIX YOUR GUT

The FIRST and most important thing is to take a GOOD probiotic.

If you've been with us for a while, we know we talk about probiotics.

A probiotic is a healthy gut bacteria that stick to your gut. Similar to the way icing sticks to a cake.

Probiotics create a healthy barrier in your bowels to keep dangerous bacteria from crashing through the lining of your intestines and entering your bloodstream (which is very bad).

They also have several beneficial effects that repair your gut and protect it from future damage.

We formulated our PROBIOTIC COMPLEX as the best gut lining defense & probiotic supplement available anywhere.

#3 FIGHT FREE RADICAL DAMAGE

To fight free radical damage, your body makes antioxidants.

Antioxidants neutralize and eliminate free radicals…but not all of them.

They work 99.9% of the time. But **the 0.1% buildup over time adds up**.

Plus, **after 30**, you make fewer antioxidants — you can no longer eliminate free radicals fast enough.

When that happens, free radicals attack the DNA of every cell (including the ones in your skin), and you start to age much faster.

The biggest weapon you've got in the fight against free radicals is antioxidants.

This is why EVERYONE should be taking antioxidants.

There's no question our favorite antioxidant is found in our NAVITOL (Pine Bark Extract).

BLOOD TEST #7
FERRITIN

If you have kids…

Then you know, traveling with them…

(Especially when they're young)

It is an adventure.

I can't tell you how often our minivan was packed so tight I couldn't even find room for a shoelace if I needed to.

I mean…

There's only so much room inside a minivan.

Of course…

If you run out of space inside the minivan…

You can always strap more stuff onto the roof.

But eventually…

You run out of space.

Now, you should know…

The same thing happens to your liver.

Let me explain…

When you eat crappy carbs (fats + sugar combined), sugar, too many carbs, overeat food in a day, or eat too often…

Your blood sugar levels SPIKE.

That's a problem because…high blood sugar levels **are toxic** and dangerous…so your body *has* to eliminate the excess glucose IMMEDIATELY.

You can't keep the extra glucose in your blood. That's life-threatening.

So…

You must somehow remove the extra glucose and quickly move it elsewhere.

This is what insulin does.

Insulin clears the glucose out of your blood and moves it into storage.

But…where exactly does insulin put the extra glucose?

Well…

You only have 3 places where you can store excess glucose…

Your MUSCLES, LIVER, and FAT CELLS.

As I mentioned earlier…

Your liver is like the minivan.

You can only pack a limited amount of glucose (glucose gets stored as glycogen in your liver).

Once your liver is full…

Your body will convert the excess glucose into fat and pack it around your liver…

Just like the family that ran out of room for stuff inside the minivan.

That's how you end up with fatty liver.

You also need to know that liver fat is a special kind of fat…

It's deadly.

A person with fatty liver gets diabetes, they don’t detoxify properly, their thyroid gets sluggish, and they end up with heart disease…

All because their body needs to find a place to store the excess glucose.

The reason I’m mentioning all this is…

Is because you need to know about FERRITIN.

All you need to know is that ferritin is a blood protein that contains IRON.

And…

If you have too much ferritin…

Then you most likely have a fatty liver as well.

Blood levels of ferritin are commonly elevated in people with fatty liver disease due to systemic inflammation, too much iron, or both.

A healthy liver plays a significant role in iron metabolism by making a protein called hepcidin.

On the other hand…

A fatty liver doesn’t make enough hepcidin…

And that leads to iron overload.

Now…

Iron overload (or accumulation) doesn’t get talked about much.

Yet, it can cause a LOT of symptoms…

Brain fog, fatigue, low sex drive, erectile dysfunction, mood swings, digestive issues, anxiety, depression, memory loss, pain, HAIR LOSS, and heart failure.

This is why people who reverse fatty liver also overcome many different symptoms.

WHAT ARE OPTIMIZED BLOOD LEVELS OF FERRITIN?

Most functional doctors agree that optimized ferritin levels are **70-150 ng/ml.**

If your ferritin levels are too high…

Then you have to fix the cause…

INSULIN RESISTANCE.

I know I sound like a broken record…

But there's a reason we talk so much about insulin.

Now…

What happens if your ferritin levels are too low?

Then…

You have a problem as well.

Low iron is common in women and causes a lot of symptoms.

You need iron to make red blood cells.

How can you feel good without enough red blood cells?

Weakness, dizziness, headaches, pale skin, fatigue, HAIR LOSS, SLUGGISH THYROID, weak nails, burning sensation of the tongue, dry skin, shortness of breath, leg pains, tinnitus, chest pain…

These are all possible symptoms.

Why are people low in iron?

First…

People are scared of red meat.

And doctors have told people they can get all the iron they need from plants.

That's FALSE!!

There are two types of iron found in food:

HEME iron and NON-HEME.

HEME iron is easily absorbed by the body.

NON-HEME is poorly absorbed by the body.

And…

HEME iron is only found in meat, eggs, oysters, clams, organ meats, and poultry.

Whereas…

NON-HEME iron is found in beans, spinach, nuts, seeds, lentils, and other plant-based foods.

Clearly…

Eating more beans or spinach will NOT fix a low iron problem.

Also…

A person with low digestive enzymes or issues will struggle with getting iron.

BLOOD TEST #8
URIC ACID

I’m a big Seinfeld fan.

One of my favorite scenes in the show involves George and his girlfriend Julie asking Elaine and Jerry for lunch.

Both said they couldn’t make it…

But Elaine asked if they could get her a “big salad.”

The scene cuts to George and Julie finishing lunch.

And, after George pays for lunch (and the big salad for Elaine)…

The waitress walks up and hands the “big salad” to Julie.

The next scene cuts to George and Julie walking into Jerry’s apartment.

Here’s the dialogue:

George: Hey, hey.

Elaine: Hey

Julie: Sorry we’re late.

Elaine: No problem.

Julie: Here’s your big salad.

Elaine: Thank you, Julie.

Julie: Oh, you’re very welcome.

[Julie exits, and Elaine leaves to go to the washroom]

George: Did you see what just happened? Did you happen to notice that Julie handed the big salad to Elaine?

Jerry, Yeah, so?

George: Well, she didn’t BUY the big salad. I bought the big salad.

Jerry: Is that a fact?

George: Yes it is. She just took credit for my salad. That’s not right.

Jerry: No it isn’t.

George: You think she would have said something?

Jerry: She could have.

George: Oh, I know.

Jerry: Imagine, her taking credit for YOUR big salad.

George: You know you buy a big salad for somebody it would be nice if they knew it.

The episode is funny because we’ve all been in that situation before.

Now…

The reason I’m sharing this with you…

Is that whenever I talk about Uric acid…

People instantly think of gout.

Gout is the taking credit…

Just like Julie did for buying the big salad.

Uric acid is a natural byproduct in your body.

Everyone has it.

But, you need to be able to filter it out of your body.

If you can't get rid of it…

Then you get symptoms.

If you've ever had gout, you know how PAINFUL it is.

But gout is only ONE of the symptoms of too much uric acid.

Most people with too much uric acid DON'T GET GOUT.

Here's the truth about uric acid:

High uric acid is a SYMPTOM of metabolic syndrome.

Less than 7% of the population (used to be 12% until recently) is metabolically healthy.

If you're not metabolically healthy…

- **Have an ideal waist measurement.**
- **Normal blood sugar levels.**
- **Normal blood pressure.**
- **Normal blood triglycerides and HDL.**

AND, you do not take any medications for any of the above…

Then you most likely have or will also have a uric acid problem.

Remember…

Metabolic syndrome is caused by hyperinsulinemia…

A fancy way of saying INSULIN RESISTANCE.

As I mentioned earlier…

Uric acid is a normal byproduct in your body.

Your kidneys normally filter it out of your body.

But…

When you have too much insulin…

Your kidneys lose the ability to get rid of uric acid.

In short, too much insulin means you accumulate uric acid.

So…

For most people…

If you FIX insulin resistance, you will fix the uric acid problem.

Now…

Doctors blame meat for uric acid.

They think all gout (and high uric acid) is caused by purine-rich foods.

But that's not true.

For some, purine-rich foods only become a problem AFTER they have an insulin problem.

The truth is…

A person with high uric acid is much more likely to have a problem with FRUCTOSE than purines.

You see…

One of the byproducts of fructose metabolism is uric acid.

Some with high uric acid can't consume any fructose without triggering symptoms.

Here’s the bottom line:

Uric acid is essentially a metabolic syndrome problem.

And…

Metabolic syndrome is essentially an insulin problem.

So…

As usual…

Fix insulin.

Bottom line:

I believe in having optimized blood levels of uric acid…

This means you should be **<u>under 5 mg/dl.</u>**

8 CRITICAL BLOOD TESTS

AND WHAT THEY SAY ABOUT YOUR HEALTH

SUMMARY

BLOOD TEST #1 THE TRIGLYCERIDE/HDL RATIO

The closer to 1 — the better. If your TG/HDL ratio is over 3, your risk of heart disease, stroke, or heart attack goes up significantly.

BLOOD TEST #2 - A1C

I consider anything over 5.4 on an A1C test to indicate insulin resistance.

BLOOD TEST #3 - B12

B12 over 800-1200

BLOOD TEST #4 - VITAMIN D

Levels greater than 60ng/ml or 150 nmol.

BLOOD TEST #5 - THYROID

TSH > 1 = SYMPTOMS

BLOOD TEST #6 - CRP

As close to 0 as possible.

BLOOD TEST #7 - FERRITIN

Optimized ferritin levels are **70-150 ng/ml.**

BLOOD TEST #8 -URIC ACID

Under 5 mg/dl.